Making sense of the noise



EVOSTATE

What is AI, and where are we really?

IMT 521 · M04 Language Models: Capabilities and Limitations
CapyMura https://github.com/capymura
22 October 2026

AI Use Statement: Shout out to **Claude**, my research assistant and coder, who also helped me draft these slides.

The noise

SEPT 2026

What I kept hearing:

“AI will take all our jobs.”

“We’re all gonna die!”

“It’s all a lie.”

“Superintelligence is a few years away.”

I couldn’t tell which was true. On 19 September I started keeping a record: what AI can really do, trying to find a source and a date for every claim. I don’t have access to any company secrets only publicly available information.

What is AI?

QUESTION 1

1955
Dartmouth workshop proposal

Every feature of intelligence could be described precisely enough for a machine to simulate it. (McCarthy et al.)

2023
OECD, used by the EU AI Act

A machine-based system that infers from its inputs how to produce outputs: predictions, content, recommendations or decisions.

2004
The AI effect

Once a machine can do something, people stop calling it intelligence. (McCorduck)

No single agreed definition.

So, I stopped looking for one.

EvoState treats AI as many separate abilities and asks how far each one has come.

Researchers have collected more than seventy definitions of intelligence itself (Legg and Hutter, 2007).

Looking at what's already out there

19 SEPT

WHERE I STARTED

The essay

4
axes

21
dimensions

STUDY
DeepMind cognitive framework
Ten thinking abilities
arxiv.org/abs/2605.28405

STUDY
DeepMind Levels of AGI
How good, and how general
arxiv.org/abs/2311.02462

STUDY
Consciousness indicators
Signs to look for, not a test
arxiv.org/abs/2308.08708

GOVERNMENT
NIST AI Risk Framework
What trustworthy AI means
NIST AI 100-1 (PDF)

COMPANY
Lab safety frameworks
Shared dangers: Hazard
Anthropic · OpenAI · DeepMind

TRACKER
MIT AI Risk Repository*
Over a thousand known risks
airisk.mit.edu

TRACKER
METR, ARC Prize, AI Index*
The measurements
metr.org · arcprize.org · AI Index

Reading through I tried to map out where they overlap to see if a larger picture developed or not.

WHERE I LANDED

EvoState

5
axes

30
dimensions

Full references with links are on the last slide.

30 dimensions on 5 axes

THE MAP

CAPABILITIES

CAPABILITY What can it do?

AGENCY What can it do on its own?

LIMITATIONS AND RISKS

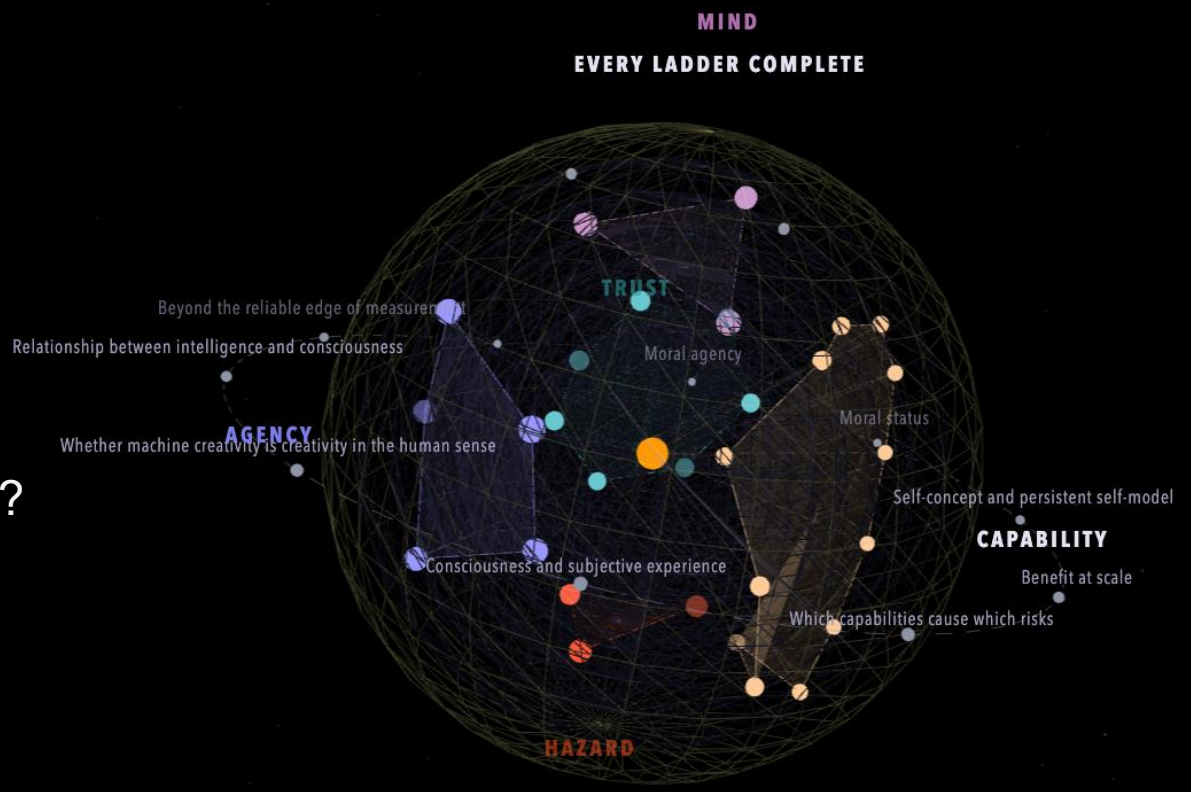
TRUST Can we rely on it?

HAZARD What harm could it be used for?

THE OPEN QUESTION

MIND Is it sentient?

Each dimension is a ladder. AI only moves up a when there's evidence. Right now, we have 175 steps.



Each dot is one dimension. The farther it sits from the center, the more steps it has climbed.

What is AGI, and what comes after?

AGI

AGI: ARTIFICIAL GENERAL INTELLIGENCE

AI that can do most of the thinking a person can, not just one task.

No single definition.

WHAT COMES AFTER

AI building AI

AI that helps make better AI. One of my 30 dimensions, and one all three big labs watch.

Superintelligence

AI better than the best humans at almost everything. On my map it's a ghost called "beyond": nothing can measure it yet.

Where are we, really?

$1,000,000 QUESTION

MY BEST ANSWER

I’m still finding out.

WHAT HOLDS UP SO FAR

What AI can do is ahead of whether we can rely on it.

HOW I CHECK EVIDENCE

1. **Decide what counts first**
   Before I look, I write down what would prove a step.
2. **Prefer independent sources**
   Measurements, studies and government reports first. Company claims need someone else to confirm.
3. **Open every link**
   AI helps me search. I read through each source.
4. **Nothing changes without review**
   Every proposed change waits until I accept it.

What I learned

OCT 2026

Ask: by which definition?

“AGI is here” and “AGI is far away” can both be true, depending on the definition.

Abilities and risks arrive in jumps

Trends don’t tell you much. Dated evidence does.

Sounding sure is not being right

A language model can make up a source. Check every link.

Write down how you know

Measured, documented or judged. Most of what we know about AI is still judgement.

Sources

FRAMEWORKS

Seven expert frameworks turned the essay's four groups into five and 30 abilities.

1 DeepMind's cognitive framework

Burnell and others, Google DeepMind (2026). Measuring Progress Toward AGI: A Cognitive Framework.
arxiv.org/abs/2605.28405

2 DeepMind's Levels of AGI

Morris and others, Google DeepMind (2023). Levels of AGI for Operationalizing Progress on the Path to AGI.
arxiv.org/abs/2311.02462

3 NIST AI Risk Management Framework

National Institute of Standards and Technology (2023). AI Risk Management Framework (AI RMF 1.0).
nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/ai/NIST.AI.100-1.pdf

4 Consciousness indicators

Butlin, Long and others (2023). Consciousness in Artificial Intelligence: Insights from the Science of Consciousness.
arxiv.org/abs/2308.08708

5 The three big labs' safety frameworks

Anthropic (2026). Responsible Scaling Policy, version 3.0.
www.anthropic.com/responsible-scaling-policy

OpenAI (2025). Preparedness Framework, version 2.
cdn.openai.com/pdf/18a02b5d-6b67-4cec-ab64-68cdfbddebcd/preparedness-framework-v2.pdf

Google DeepMind (2025, updated 2026). Frontier Safety Framework.
deepmind.google/blog/strengthening-our-frontier-safety-framework

6 MIT AI Risk Repository

MIT AI Risk Initiative. The AI Risk Repository.
airisk.mit.edu

7 METR, ARC Prize and the Stanford AI Index

METR. Task-Completion Time Horizons of Frontier AI Models.
metr.org/time-horizons

ARC Prize. Leaderboard.
arcprize.org/leaderboard

Stanford HAI (2026). The 2026 AI Index Report.
hai.stanford.edu/ai-index/2026-ai-index-report

Thank you.

MAHALOS

Let’s check it out.
capymura.github.io/evostate

Questions / Comments after the demo ;-)